
Recitation 2: HTML & CSS

Shakespeare

Act 1. Scene 1. Thunder and Lightning. Enter three Witches. First Witch: "When shall we three meet again? In thunder, lightning, or in rain?" Second Witch: "When the hurly-burly's done, when the battle's lost and won." Third Witch: "That will be ere the set of sun." First Witch: "Where the place?" Second Witch: "Upon the heath." Third Witch: "There to meet with Macbeth." First Witch: "I come, Graymalkin." Second Witch: "Paddock calls." Third Witch: "Anon." All: "Fair is foul, and foul is fair; Hover through the fog and filthy air." They exit.

ACT 1

Scene 1

Thunder and Lightning. Enter three Witches.

FIRST WITCH

~~When shall we three meet again?~~

In thunder, lightning, or in rain?

SECOND WITCH

When the hurly-burly's done,

When the battle's lost and won.

THIRD WITCH

That will be ere the set of sun.

FIRST WITCH

Where the place?

SECOND WITCH Upon the heath.

THIRD WITCH

There to meet with Macbeth.

FIRST WITCH I come, Graymalkin.

「SECOND WITCH」 Paddock calls.

「THIRD WITCH」 Anon.

ALL

Fair is foul, and foul is fair;

Hover through the fog and filthy air.

They exit.

MACBETH, *aside* Glamis and Thane of Cawdor!

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The greatest is behind. *To Ross and Angus.* Thanks
for your pains.

Aside to Banquo. Do you not hope your children
shall be kings,

When those that gave the Thane of Cawdor to me
Promised no less to them?

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BANQUO That, trusted home,
Might yet enkindle you unto the crown,
Besides the Thane of Cawdor. But 'tis strange.
And oftentimes, to win us to our harm,
The instruments of darkness tell us truths,
Win us with honest trifles, to betray 's
In deepest consequence.—
Cousins, a word, I pray you.

They step aside.

MACBETH, *aside* Two truths are told

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act 1 scene 1 thunder and lightning enter three
witches first witch when shall we three meet
again in thunder lightning or in rain second witch
when the hurlyburlys done when the battles lost
and won third witch that will be ere the set of sun
first witch where the place second witch upon the
heath third witch there to meet with macbeth
first witch i come graymalkin second witch
paddock calls third witch anon all fair is foul and
foul is fair hover through the fog and filthy air
they exit

HTML

Hyper Can distinguish data/content from metadata

Text Encodes text documents*

Markup Extra syntax encodes metadata

Language Is itself a written thing

**later becomes multimedia*

Also: extensible!

CSS

Cascading Rules inherited & applied by specificity

Style Separation of style and content

Sheets Portable, declarative, textual

The “not nots” of HTML and CSS

What features of the design of these languages is it *not* okay *not* to have?

Imagine removing the “cascading” part of CSS: what bad situation reveals itself? How does the feature function as an innovation that mitigates the bad situation?

Using this method of analysis we can recover the exciting forward narrative of the design of the technology.

The “not nots” of HTML and CSS

- Markup for opening and closing tags/nesting: `</>`
- id attributes: `<h2 id="part2">Part 2</h2>`
- Selectors: `div.container { ... }`
- `scroll-behavior` rule

Some failures that inspired further innovations:

HTML's verbosity for simple document authoring → Markdown

CSS's lack of nesting & abstraction → Sass/SCSS

Feature

Feature: Markup!

Syntax: <...>

Bad situation (not not): Can't distinguish content from context (metadata)

Concept: Tagging

Feature:

Syntax:

Bad situation (not not):

Concept:

Feature:

Syntax:

Bad situation (not not):

Concept:

Notes

Reminders

- class website @ web.mit.edu/6.104
- [assignment E2](#) due Monday 11:59pm
- [office hours](#) Sunday 1-3pm, Monday 6-8pm, Friday 3-5pm
- post any questions/concerns on Commons (do not email staff)
 - [request access](#) to Commons if you're still not registered